

Department of Computer Science  
Universitas Muhammadiyah Malang  
Jl. Raya Tlogomas 246, Malang 65144  
East Java, Indonesia

March 13, 2026

The Editor  
Journal of Open Archaeology Data  
Ubiquity Press

Dear Editor,

I am pleased to submit the manuscript “The Colonial Archaeological Register of Java: A Digitized Database of Site Observations from Dutch *Oudheidkundig Verslag* Reports (1912–1929)” for consideration as a Data Paper in the *Journal of Open Archaeology Data*.

This paper presents the first structured, georeferenced database extracted from the Dutch colonial *Oudheidkundig Verslag* (OV) reports — the primary documentary record of archaeological work in the Netherlands East Indies during 1912–1929. The Colonial Archaeological Register of Java (CARJ) contains 52 site observations with burial depth measurements, material descriptions, volcanic context, and condition assessments. To my knowledge, no previous attempt has been made to systematically digitize these colonial archaeological records into a machine-readable format.

The dataset is particularly valuable because it preserves primary observations of sites that are now inaccessible or lost: a preliminary cross-reference with modern Indonesian heritage databases indicates that 54% of colonial entries have no identifiable modern counterpart. Of these “lost sites,” 21 have burial depth measurements that represent irreplaceable data on volcanic sedimentation processes affecting the Javanese archaeological record.

The dataset has been deposited on Zenodo [DOI to be inserted after upload] under a CC BY 4.0 license, in CSV format.

**APC waiver request.** I respectfully request a full waiver of the article processing charge. This research was conducted without external funding at Universitas Muhammadiyah Malang, Indonesia, which does not provide APC support for journal publications. The dataset serves a public heritage interest by making colonial-era archaeological observations freely available for the first time, and I believe the contribution aligns with JOAD’s mission of promoting open data in archaeology.

This manuscript has not been submitted elsewhere and is not under consideration at any other

journal. The author declares no competing interests.

Sincerely,

Mukhlis Amien  
Department of Computer Science  
Universitas Muhammadiyah Malang  
ORCID: 0000-0002-1848-167X  
`mukhlis.amien@umm.ac.id`